

Assurance Of Salvation

doc-assurance-of-salvation

Soteriology · Assurance · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

breadth canon-wide

directness direct

variants stable

Statement under examination

Believers may have well-grounded assurance of salvation, founded on the promises of God in Christ, the inward witness of the Spirit, and the evidence of Spirit-wrought fruit.

In plain language

The verses cited point one way. In 1 John 5:13 the writer states his purpose with 'so that you may know' (hina eidete), built on the word for purpose plus 'to know with settled knowledge' (oida), a verb of settled knowing (here a perfect-stem form, a completed-state form, confirmed by querying the text), and his goal is that people who believe may KNOW they HAVE eternal life right now, using present-tense possession. That is assurance grounded in a promise. In 2 Timothy 1:12 the same verb appears as 'I know' (oida), I know whom I have believed, the personal form of that knowledge. In Romans 8:16 the verb 'co-bears witness' (symmartyrei) means the Spirit bears witness together WITH our spirit that we are children of God. That verb occurs only three times in the whole New Testament and always means a joint, co-attesting testimony, so it names a genuinely inward ground, the witness of the Spirit. Romans 5:1-5 starts from having been justified, which yields peace toward God, then builds a chain: pressure produces endurance, endurance produces proven character, and proven character produces hope, a hope that does not put us to shame because the love of God has been poured out in our hearts. The word 'proven character' or 'tested genuineness' (dokime) describes tested, demonstrated genuineness, the third ground, fruit worked by the Spirit. Hebrews 10:22 names 'full assurance of faith' (plerophoria pisteos) outright, a word that means complete certainty and appears only four times, and ties it to a heart already sprinkled and washed. Second Peter 1:10 tells believers to make their calling and election 'firm' (bebaios), a word that means guaranteed. One verse pulls the other way: Second Corinthians 13:5 commands 'examine yourselves' (dokimazete), using the same 'test/prove' root that elsewhere means proven, and warns of being 'disqualified' (adokimos, failing the test). But that command tests a reality, it does not deny that assurance exists. So across an apostle, two letters of Paul, and Hebrews the same picture holds: believers may rest in a confidence anchored in the promise, the Spirit's witness, and visible fruit. What the words do not settle is which of those three grounds weighs most, or whether assurance is built into faith from the start or grows as a separate confidence over time. That open question, not any doubt about whether assurance exists, is where careful readers honestly diverge. The pattern is consistent and the verdict affirms the proposition.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
G0026	ἀγάπη	agape	love	116
G0096	ἀδόκιμος	adokimos	failing	
G0166	αἰώνιος	aionios	eternal	69
G0228	ἀληθινός	alethinos	true	28
G0949	βέβαιος	bebaios	firm	8

G1097	γινώσκω	ginōskō	to know	
G1344	δικαιόω	dikaioo	to justify	39
G1381	δοκιμάζω	dokimazō	to test	
G1382	δοκιμή	dokime	test	7
G1492	οἶδα	oida	to perceive	293
G1515	εἰρήνη	eirene	peace	91
G1680	ἐλπίς	elpis	hope	53
G2192	ἔχω	echo	to have/be	765
G2316	θεός	theos	God	
G2347	θλίψις	thlipsis	pressure	
G2443	ἵνα	hina	in order that/to	722
G2588	καρδιά	kardia	heart	
G2744	καυχάομαι	kauchaomai	to boast	
G3140	μαρτυρέω	martureō	to testify	
G4100	πιστεύω	pisteuo	to trust (in)	241
G4135	πληροφορέω	plērophoreō	to fulfill	
G4136	πληροφορία	plerophoria	assurance	4
G4828	συμμαρτυρέω	symmartyreō	to testify with	3
G5281	ὑπομονή	hypomone	perseverance	32

Plain meanings: STEPbible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

The cited verses converge on a settled, knowable confidence whose ground lies outside the believer. In 1 John 5:13 the purpose clause 'so that you may know' (hina eidete) uses the verb 'to know with settled knowledge' (oida, G1492) in the perfect subjunctive (V-RAS-2P, a completed-state form used after 'so that', queried in the source), the verb of settled knowing, governing 'you have' (echete, G2192, present indicative V-PAI-2P, an ongoing simple statement of fact), so the writer's stated aim is that believers may KNOW they presently HAVE eternal life. Romans 8:16 uses 'co-bears witness' (symmartyreō, G4828, present indicative V-PAI-3S, an ongoing simple statement of fact, queried as 1 of only 3 occurrences in the whole Bible), the Spirit co-witnessing with our spirit, an inward ground. Hebrews 10:22 names 'full assurance of faith' (plerophoria pisteos, G4136, full certainty of faith), and 2 Peter 1:10 commands making one's calling and election 'firm' (bebaios, G0949, secure or guaranteed). The three named grounds, the promise, the Spirit's witness, and Spirit-wrought fruit (called 'proven character' or 'tested genuineness' (dokime, G1382)), are each lexically present. The genuine nuance the words leave open is the relative weight of objective promise, inward witness, and evidential fruit, not whether assurance exists.

Scripture

1John.5.13 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1492 οἶδα, G2192 ἔχω, G0166 αἰώνιος, G4100 πιστεύω, G2443 ἵνα

Force. Queried morphology: 'you may know' (eidete, from oida, G1492) is V-RAS-2P, a perfect-stem subjunctive (a completed-state form used after 'so that') of settled knowing inside the purpose clause 'so that you may know' (hina eidete), and 'you have' (echete, from echo, G2192) is V-PAI-2P, present possession (ongoing simple statement that they currently possess it). The writer's stated aim is that those who believe ('the ones believing' (pisteuousin), present participle, an ongoing-action describing noun-form) may KNOW that they HAVE eternal life ('life eternal' (zoeon aionion)) now. The grammar locates assurance in present possession verified by a knowledge verb, not in future attainment or probability.

Rom.8.16 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4828 συμμαρτυρέω, G2316 θεός

Force. Queried: 'co-bears witness' (symmartyrei, G4828) is V-PAI-3S (third-person ongoing simple statement of fact) and occurs only 3 times in the whole Bible (Romans 8:16, Romans 9:1, Romans 2:15), each time the 'with' or 'together' prefix (syn-) making the testimony joint and co-attesting. Here the Spirit bears witness WITH our spirit that we are 'children of God' (tekna theou). The near-rare verb is unambiguous in sense, an inward co-witness, which the proposition names as the second ground of assurance.

Rom.5.1 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1344 δικαιώω, G1515 εἰρήνη

Force. The aorist (completed past action) passive participle 'having been justified' (dikaiouthentes) grounds the indicative 'we have peace toward God' (eirenen echomen pros ton theon). The settled status precedes and produces the relational peace, so assurance rests on an accomplished justification 'out of faith' (ek pisteos). 'To justify' or 'to declare righteous' (dikaioo, G1344) clusters heavily in Romans and Galatians, a stable forensic (courtroom-verdict) sense across the queried distribution.

Rom.5.2 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1680 ἐλπίς, G2744 καυχάομαι

Force. 'We boast in hope of the glory of God' (kauchometha ep elpidi tes doxes tou theou) sets confident hope as the standing posture of those who have 'access' (prosagogen) into this grace. 'Hope' (elpis, G1680) in the queried canon spread denotes confident expectation, not mere wish, so the boasting is forward-looking confidence rather than presumption.

Rom.5.3 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2347 θλίψις, G5281 ὑπομονή

Force. The chain begins 'tribulation produces endurance' (thlipsis hypomonen katergazetai). Suffering is not a counter-witness to assurance but feeds the progression toward proven character. 'Endurance' (hypomone, G5281) carries a stable sense of steadfast endurance across its 32 queried occurrences.

Rom.5.4 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5281 ὑπομονή, G1382 δοκιμή, G1680 ἐλπίς

Force. 'Endurance produces proven character, and proven character produces hope' (hypomone dokimen, dokime de elpida). 'Proven character' or 'tested genuineness' (dokime, G1382, queried at 7 occurrences) denotes tested, demonstrated genuineness, the lexical core of Spirit-wrought evidence feeding back into confident hope. Its cognate (a related word from the same root) 'failing the test' or 'disqualified' (adokimos, G0096) names the failed-test outcome, so the same dokim- root (the 'test/prove' word-family) supplies both the evidence of assurance and the standard of self-examination.

Rom.5.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1680 ἐλπίς, G0026 ἀγάπη

Force. 'The hope does not put to shame' (he elpis ou kataischynei), grounded in 'the love of God has been poured out in our hearts' (he agape tou theou ekkechytai en tais kardiais hemon) 'through the Holy Spirit' (dia pneumatou hagiou). The perfect tense 'has been poured out' (ekkechytai, a completed action whose result still stands) marks an abiding poured-out state, the inward affective ground of unfailing hope. 'Love' (agape, G0026) here is God's love toward us, the source, not our love as merit.

Heb.10.22 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4136 πληροφορία, G2588 καρδιά, G0228 ἀληθινός

Force. 'Let us draw near in full assurance of faith' (proserchometha en plerophoria pisteos) with 'a true heart' (alethines kardias). 'Full assurance' or 'full certainty' (plerophoria, G4136, queried N-DSF, a noun in the 'in/by/with' grammatical form) occurs only 4 times (Hebrews 10:22, Hebrews 6:11, 1 Thessalonians 1:5, Colossians 2:2) and denotes fullness and complete certainty in every instance. The participles 'having been sprinkled' (rerantismenoi) and 'having been washed' (lélousmenoi) (perfect-tense forms describing completed actions whose results still stand) ground that assurance in an accomplished cleansing.

2Pet.1.10 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0949 βέβαιος, G4100 πιστεύω

Force. 'Be diligent to make your calling and election firm' (spoudasate bebaian hymon ten klesin kai eklogen poieisthai). 'Firm' or 'secure' (bebaios, G0949, queried A-ASF, an adjective in a particular grammatical form, 8 occurrences including 2 Peter 1:19, Hebrews 3:14, Hebrews 6:19, Romans 4:16) denotes firm, secure, guaranteed. The middle-voice infinitive 'to make' (poieisthai, a verb form where the subject acts on or for itself) casts assurance as something the believer confirms experientially through diligence, the evidential ground, while 'you will never stumble' (ptaisete pote) attaches the promise.

2Tim.1.12 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1492 οἶδα, G4100 πιστεύω

Force. Queried: 'I know' (oida, G1492) here is V-RAI-1S (first-person perfect indicative, a completed-state simple statement of fact), 'I know whom I have believed' (oida ho pepisteuka). The first-person settled-knowledge verb pairs with the perfect 'I have believed' (pepisteuka, a completed action whose result still stands, an enduring state of having believed), so the assurance is personal, present, and grounded in the object of faith. This is the same 'I know' (oida) that 1 John 5:13 makes the writer's aim for all believers.

2Cor.13.5 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1381 δοκιμάζω, G0096 ἀδόκιμος

Force. Queried: 'test yourselves' (heautous peirazete, G3985, V-PAM-2P, second-person plural present command) and 'examine yourselves' (heautous dokimazete, G1381, V-PAM-2P, second-person plural present command) are present imperatives (ongoing commands), test and examine yourselves, with the cognate 'failing the test' or 'disqualified' (adokimoi, G0096) naming the disqualified outcome. The same 'test/prove' root (dokim-) that grounds assurance in Romans 5:4 ('proven character' (dokime), proven) here funds a command to test whether Christ is in you. The text presents assurance and self-examination together, not in opposition.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
1John.5.13	1John.5.10	tsk	1
1John.5.13	1John.1.4	tsk	1
Heb.10.22	Heb.10.19	tsk	1

Heb.10.22	Heb.4.16	tsk	1
Heb.10.22	Heb.9.13	tsk	1
Rom.8.16	Rom.8.23	tsk	1
Rom.5.1	Rom.5.9	tsk	1
Rom.5.2	Rom.5.5	tsk	1
Rom.5.5	Isa.44.3	tsk	1
2Pet.1.10	2Tim.2.19	tsk	1
2Pet.1.10	Rom.8.28	tsk	1
2Pet.1.10	2Pet.3.17	tsk	1

Complicating texts

2Cor.13.5 · addressed

The present imperatives (ongoing commands) 'examine yourselves' (dokimazete) and 'test yourselves' (peirazete) (queried V-PAM-2P, second-person plural present command, test and examine yourselves) with the cognate 'failing the test' or 'disqualified' (adokimoi, G0096, queried at 8 occurrences including 2 Corinthians 13:5, 13:6, 13:7) could be read as making assurance perpetually unsettled. Lexically the same 'test/prove' root (dokim-) grounds assurance in Romans 5:4 ('proven character' or 'tested genuineness' (dokime), proven genuineness) and funds the test here, so the verse does not deny assurance but anchors it in a verifiable reality (whether Christ is in you). The examination is the means by which evidential assurance is confirmed, not a withholding of it.

2Pet.1.10 · addressed

The command 'be diligent to make firm' (spoudasate bebaian poieisthai) could be read as making assurance contingent on works. Lexically the middle voice 'to make' (poieisthai, a verb form where the subject acts on or for itself) concerns the believer confirming and experiencing an election already grounded in God's prior 'calling' (klesis) and 'choosing' (ekloge), supported by the cross-reference to 2 Timothy 2:19 (the firm foundation stands, the Lord knows those who are his). The verse supports evidential assurance through Spirit-wrought diligence rather than earning the promise.

Heb.10.22 · addressed

The hortatory subjunctive 'let us draw near' (proserchometha, a 'let us do X' verb form) is a summons, which could be read as conditional (an 'if-then' arrangement). But 'full assurance of faith' (plerophoria pisteos, full certainty of faith) is presented as the present possession enabling the approach, and the perfect participles (completed actions whose results still stand) 'having been sprinkled' (rerantismenoi) and 'having been washed' (lousmenoi) anchor it in completed cleansing, so the exhortation presupposes assurance rather than withholding it.

Concordance traversed

G1492, G1097, G4828, G3140, G4136, G4135, G0949, G2192, G2443, G0166, G4100, G1515, G1344, G1680, G1382, G0096, G5281, G0026, G0228, G2588, G2744

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

The lexical store holds 116 VariantUnit nodes, all within the 3 John CBGM window (the Coherence-Based Genealogical Method, a textual-criticism tool published only for select books), so none of the cited assurance verses fall in published or shadow CBGM scope. 1 John 5:13 carries known manuscript variation in the relative-clause word order around 'to the ones believing in the name' (tois pisteuousin eis to onoma), but the queried 'so that you may know' (hina eidete) clause that carries the verdict is textually stable, so the verdict holds across plausible readings.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. perseverance, conditional_perseverance, assurance_of_the_essence_of_faith, assurance_as_distinct_attainment

analogia scripturae invoked

assurance grounded chiefly in the objective promise: for · Weights 1 John 5:13 ('so that you may know' (hina eidete), the writer's aim that believers KNOW) and 2 Timothy 1:12 ('I know' (oida), I know whom I have believed) as locating assurance primarily in the promise of God received by faith, so that assurance belongs to the essence of believing. The queried perfect-stem 'to know' (oida) (a completed-state knowing-verb) and present 'you have' (echete, an ongoing simple statement of present possession) support reading assurance as a present given rather than a later prize.

assurance grounded chiefly in the inward witness of the Spirit: for · Weights Romans 8:16 'co-bears witness' (symmartyrei) (the Spirit co-witnesses) and Romans 5:5 (the love of God poured out by the Spirit) as the experiential, affective ground. On this reading assurance is felt confirmation, not bare inference from the promise. The queried near-rare 'to co-bear witness' (symmartyreo), always co-attesting, supports a genuinely inward testimony.

assurance grounded chiefly in Spirit-wrought fruit and self-examination: for · Weights 2 Peter 1:10 (make your calling and election 'firm' (bebaios, secure)) and 2 Corinthians 13:5 ('examine yourselves' (dokimazete)) as making assurance a verified reality tested by evidence of a changed life. On this reading assurance can be a distinct attainment that grows with diligence. The shared 'test/prove' root (dokim-) in Romans 5:4 'proven character' (dokime) and 2 Corinthians 13:5 supports an evidential ground, and the queried 'failing the test' or 'disqualified' (adokimos) shows the test can register a negative result.

The proposition states only that believers MAY have well-grounded assurance founded on three named grounds (the promise, the Spirit's witness, and Spirit-wrought fruit). All three lenses affirm that such assurance exists lexically. They diverge on which ground is primary and on whether assurance is inseparable from faith or a distinct attainment confirmed over time. The vocabulary supports the existence and the three grounds but does not rank them, which is the honest source of legitimate divergence.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem uses the modal MAY have and lists three grounds (promises of God, inward witness of the Spirit, Spirit-wrought fruit) that map directly to queried lexical features ('you may know' (eidete) plus 'you have eternal life' (echete zoen aionion) in 1 John 5:13, 'co-bears witness' (symmartyrei) in Romans 8:16, 'proven character' (dokime) in Romans 5:4 and 'firm' (bebaios) in 2 Peter 1:10). It does not embed a tradition-specific taxonomy such as a particular full-assurance-versus-faith-assurance scheme, so it is not verdict-preloaded. The verdict is derived from the words, not the stem.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1John.5.13
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	2Tim.1.12
morphology	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Rom.8.16
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0949
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4136
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	2Cor.13.5
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	2Pet.1.10

License audit

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MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes
MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no
TSK	public_domain	yes

Flags

ecm-shadow